

What AI tools do you often use?

Doubao has become my often-used AI tool for English learning because it's conveniently available on my phone. Actually, I just got a new phone a month before the start of the semester. The new phone came pre-installed with an AI app like Doubao, which made it very convenient for me to use. Before that, I had never used similar AI apps on my phone. I had always viewed AI agents as formal assistants to help with my coding work, and I never thought I could use them in my daily life. I've been using it daily for the past two months, and its versatility has impressed me. Whether I need help understanding complex grammar points (like when to use 'would' versus 'used to') or brainstorming ideas for English essays, Doubao provides clear, contextually relevant explanations. I particularly value its voice input feature—since it's on my phone, I can easily dictate sentences and get immediate feedback on my pronunciation. The app also offers a 'Daily English' section with tailored exercises based on my learning goals, which helps me stay consistent.

Which sections have you tried?

Writing Assistance & Editing: Writing is where I've seen the most dramatic improvement. With Doubao on my phone, I can draft English messages, emails, or even short paragraphs anytime inspiration strikes. I particularly value its 'Rewrite in English' feature, which takes my Chinese thoughts and transforms them into natural-sounding English while preserving my original meaning. I also use it to explain idiomatic expressions I encounter in my reading, deepening my understanding.

What are the advantages and drawbacks of using AI in language learning?

Advantages:

- **Personalized Learning Experience:** "AI tools excel at adapting to individual learning styles and pace. For example, when I struggle with a particular grammar point, Doubao will automatically generate more practice exercises focused on that area, rather than moving on to new material. This personalized approach ensures I master concepts before progressing."
- **Instant, Detailed Feedback:** "The speed of AI feedback is transformative. When I make a mistake in writing or pronunciation using Doubao, I receive correction immediately—often with explanations of why the error occurred and how to fix it. This contrasts with traditional learning, where I might wait days for a teacher's feedback."

- Flexibility and Accessibility: "AI tools eliminate time and location constraints. With Doubao on my phone, I can practice at 2 a.m. if I want, or squeeze in a quick session during my commute. This flexibility has made consistent practice much easier to maintain."
- Low-Stress Environment: "Speaking with AI reduces the anxiety many learners feel when practicing with native speakers. I can make mistakes without feeling self-conscious, which has helped me build confidence before engaging in real conversations."

Drawbacks:

- Potential for Inaccuracies: "While generally reliable, AI tools aren't infallible. I've noticed Doubao occasionally provides explanations that are overly simplified or, in rare cases, incorrect—particularly with more complex grammatical structures or cultural nuances. This means I still need to verify information with other sources."
- Risk of Over-Reliance: "There's a danger of becoming too dependent on AI for writing or conversation. I've caught myself hesitating to write emails without Doubao's assistance, which makes me worry about my ability to produce accurate English independently in high-pressure situations."
- Limited Contextual Understanding: "AI tools excel at processing large volumes of information but often fall short of understanding the nuanced context of a conversation or piece of writing. For example, when I'm trying to express a complex idea using Doubao, I sometimes find that it's not able to capture the full meaning. This limitation requires careful attention to detail and sometimes human intervention."